



**SPARTAN**  
**INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL**  
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# INVESTIGATORY PROJECT

## ON ENGLISH

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CLASS : XII

TOPIC : GOOGLE



## Acknowledgement

I, **Joel Jebitto O**, a student of **Spartan International School**, would like to express my sincere gratitude to my English teacher for guiding me in the preparation of this investigative project. I am also thankful to my school for providing an opportunity to explore a contemporary topic that connects language, technology, business and society.

I extend my thanks to my parents, classmates and respondents who helped me with ideas and feedback. Publicly available sources such as Alphabet investor releases, Google official blogs, StatCounter Global Stats, government publications and news reports were used for updated information and statistics.

This project helped me understand how a company like Google affects everyday digital life through search, advertising, maps, video, AI tools, cloud computing and data handling. It also helped me examine both the benefits and risks of modern technology.

| Prepared by    | School                       |
|----------------|------------------------------|
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# 1. Introduction to Google

Google is one of the world's most influential technology companies. It began as a search engine and gradually expanded into advertising, mobile software, online video, cloud computing, digital payments, maps, productivity tools, hardware and artificial intelligence.

The company was founded by Larry Page and Sergey Brin in 1998. Today, Google operates under Alphabet Inc., its parent company. Google's products affect how people search for information, learn, communicate, travel, shop, create content and run businesses.

## Core Mission

Google's long-standing mission is to organize the world's information and make it universally accessible and useful. In the present decade, this mission is being transformed by generative AI, which allows users to ask longer, more complex questions and receive summarized or conversational answers.

## Major Products and Services

|                                                                                           |                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Search</b><br><br>Google Search, AI Overviews, AI Mode, Lens and local search results. | <b>Communication</b><br><br>Gmail, Google Meet, Chat and Calendar.                                 |
| <b>Productivity</b><br><br>Docs, Sheets, Slides, Drive, Classroom and Workspace.          | <b>Platforms</b><br><br>Android, Chrome, Google Play and developer services.                       |
| <b>Media</b><br><br>YouTube, YouTube Music and creator monetization tools.                | <b>AI and Cloud</b><br><br>Gemini, Vertex AI, Google Cloud, TPUs and enterprise AI infrastructure. |

## 2. History and Evolution of Google

Google's history shows how a university research project became a global platform company. Its early strength came from better search ranking, especially PageRank, which used links between webpages as a signal of importance. Later, Google expanded into advertising, mobile software, maps, video, browsers, cloud and AI.

| Year | Milestone                                                              |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1996 | Larry Page and Sergey Brin develop BackRub at Stanford University.     |
| 1998 | Google Inc. is founded in California.                                  |
| 2004 | Gmail is launched; Google becomes a public company.                    |
| 2005 | Google Maps launches; Google acquires Android.                         |
| 2006 | Google acquires YouTube.                                               |
| 2008 | Chrome browser is launched.                                            |
| 2015 | Alphabet Inc. becomes Google's parent company.                         |
| 2023 | Bard and Gemini-era AI tools begin expanding.                          |
| 2024 | AI Overviews begin appearing in Search.                                |
| 2025 | AI Mode, Gemini 2.5 and agentic shopping are announced at Google I/O.  |
| 2026 | Alphabet reports strong Search, Cloud and AI-driven growth in Q1 2026. |

*Source note: General history from Google/About Google materials and Alphabet investor materials; recent AI and financial updates from Google and Alphabet official releases.*

### 3. Google's Current Business Model

Google follows a platform business model. It attracts users through free or low-cost services, organizes digital attention and intent, and monetizes that attention mainly through advertising and enterprise services.

#### Main Revenue Streams

|                                                                                                        |                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advertising</b><br><br>Search ads, YouTube ads, display ads, shopping ads and ads on partner sites. | <b>Cloud</b><br><br>Infrastructure, data analytics, cybersecurity, Workspace and AI products for enterprises. |
| <b>Subscriptions</b><br><br>YouTube Premium, YouTube Music, Google One and consumer AI plans.          | <b>Platforms and Devices</b><br><br>Google Play, Android ecosystem, Pixel devices and other hardware.         |

#### Business Cycle

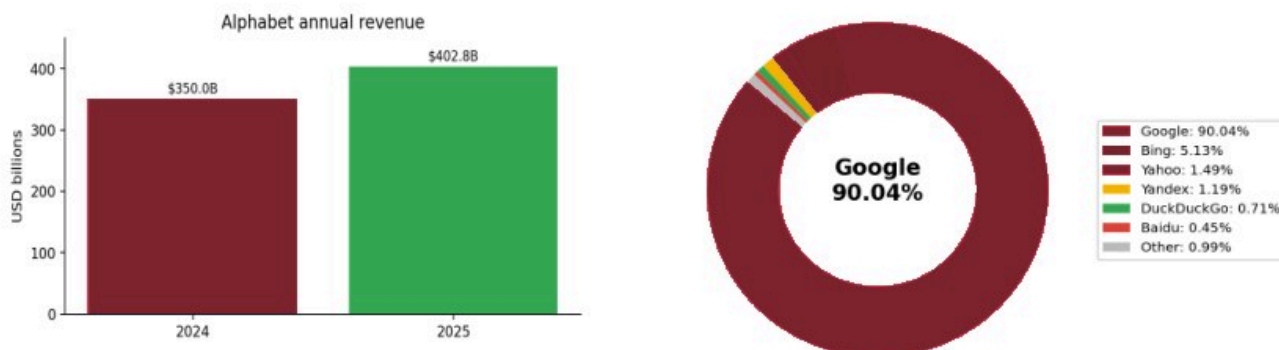
| Step | Explanation                                                         |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Useful free services attract a large user base.                     |
| 2    | User intent and engagement create advertising opportunities.        |
| 3    | Advertisers pay to reach relevant audiences.                        |
| 4    | Revenue funds infrastructure, AI research and new products.         |
| 5    | New products strengthen the ecosystem and increase user dependence. |

Investigative point: This model is powerful because users do not always pay directly with money. Instead, they often pay indirectly through attention, data and platform dependence.

## 4. Updated Statistics Dashboard

The following dashboard uses updated public figures available up to May 2026. These figures show that Alphabet remains a highly profitable company while also shifting more strongly toward AI and cloud infrastructure.

Worldwide search engine market share - April 2026

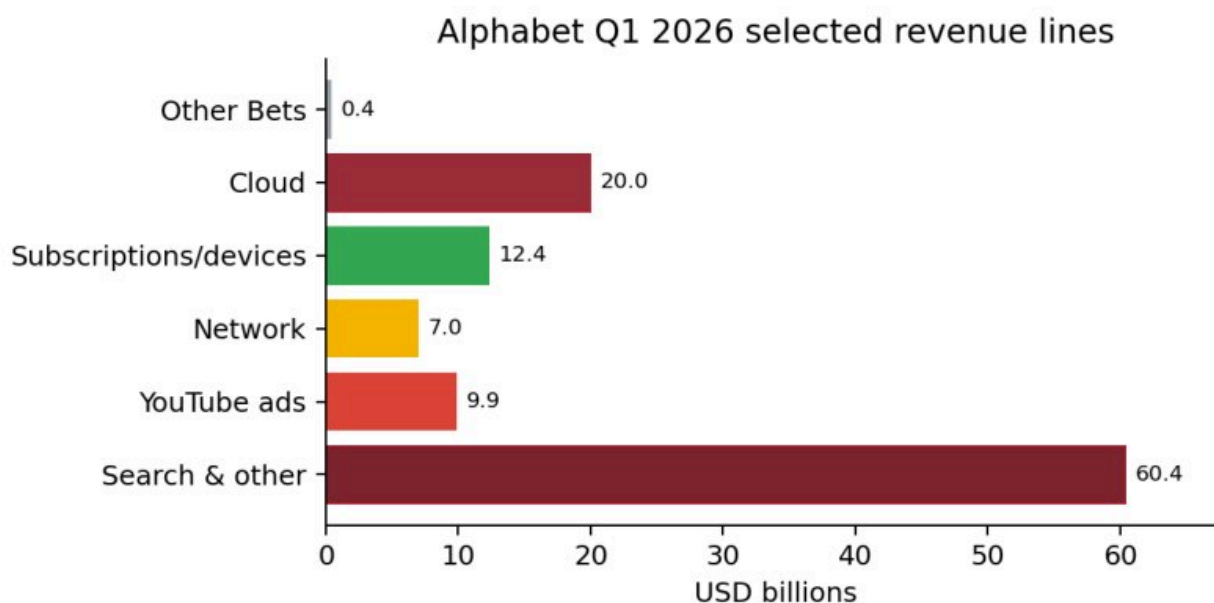


Source note: Alphabet FY 2025 earnings release for revenue; StatCounter Global Stats for April 2026 search engine market share.

| Metric                        | Updated figure    | Meaning                 |
|-------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|
| Alphabet FY 2025 revenue      | \$402.836 billion | Up 15% year-on-year     |
| Alphabet Q1 2026 revenue      | \$109.896 billion | Up 22% year-on-year     |
| Google Search & other Q1 2026 | \$60.399 billion  | Up 19% year-on-year     |
| YouTube ads Q1 2026           | \$9.883 billion   | Up 11% year-on-year     |
| Google Cloud Q1 2026          | \$20.028 billion  | Up 63% year-on-year     |
| Worldwide search share        | Google: 90.04%    | StatCounter, April 2026 |

## 5. Advertising Revenue and Google Ads

Advertising remains Google's most important revenue engine. Search advertising is especially valuable because it targets users at the moment they express intent, such as searching for a product, service, route, school, restaurant or solution to a problem.



*Source note: Alphabet Q1 2026 earnings release: selected revenue lines include Search & other \$60.399B, YouTube ads \$9.883B, Google Network \$6.971B, subscriptions/devices \$12.384B and Google Cloud \$20.028B.*

### How Google Ads Works

|                                                                                               |                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advertiser bids</b><br><br>A business selects keywords, audience signals and budget.       | <b>Auction happens</b><br><br>When a user searches, Google evaluates ad relevance, bid and quality.        |
| <b>Ad appears</b><br><br>The user sees sponsored results, shopping ads, map ads or video ads. | <b>Performance is measured</b><br><br>Clicks, impressions, conversions and return on ad spend are tracked. |

Updated angle: AI-driven campaigns such as Performance Max and AI Max are increasingly used to automate targeting, creative combinations and conversion optimization.



## 6. Search Engine Optimization and Evolution

Search Engine Optimization, or SEO, is the practice of improving websites so that search engines can understand and rank them. Earlier SEO was often focused on keywords and backlinks. Modern SEO is broader: it includes user experience, page speed, mobile design, content quality, structured data and expertise.

### Evolution of Search Results

| Period            | Main development                                                                      |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1990s-early 2000s | Keyword matching, directory-style search and link analysis.                           |
| 2000s             | PageRank, AdWords, universal search, maps and image/video results.                    |
| 2010s             | Mobile-first indexing, semantic search, RankBrain and BERT.                           |
| 2020s             | AI Overviews, Lens, multimodal search, conversational queries and generative answers. |

### Current SEO Priorities

- Helpful, original and reliable content rather than keyword stuffing.
- Fast-loading pages, mobile-friendly design and clear navigation.
- Author expertise, trustworthy references and updated information.
- Structured data that helps search engines understand products, reviews, recipes, events and organizations.
- Optimization for AI answers and zero-click search environments.

Investigative point: AI search may reduce website visits because users can receive answers directly on the search page. This creates a tension between user convenience and publisher traffic.

## 7. AI Search: AI Overviews and AI Mode

Google Search is moving from a list of webpages toward an AI-assisted answer engine. AI Overviews summarize information above or within search results. AI Mode enables longer, more conversational questions and follow-up exploration.

At Google I/O 2025, Google said AI Overviews had scaled to 1.5 billion monthly users across 200 countries and territories. Google also said AI Overviews were driving over 10% higher usage for the types of queries where they appeared in major markets such as the U.S. and India.

### AI Search Flow

| Step | Process                                                                          |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | User asks a complex question.                                                    |
| 2    | Google retrieves web, shopping, local, image, video and knowledge graph signals. |
| 3    | Gemini-based systems summarize, compare and organize results.                    |
| 4    | The search page presents an AI Overview, links and follow-up paths.              |
| 5    | User may click sources, refine the query or complete a task.                     |

### Benefits and Concerns

| Benefits                                                                                              | Concerns                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Faster answers, easier research, better handling of long questions and support for multimodal inputs. | Possible factual errors, reduced traffic to publishers, source transparency issues and overdependence on AI summaries. |

Source note: Google I/O 2025 official blog, AI Overviews update.

## 8. Google Cloud and AI Infrastructure

Google Cloud is Alphabet's enterprise technology division. It provides cloud infrastructure, databases, analytics, cybersecurity, Workspace collaboration tools and AI services. As AI adoption increases, cloud infrastructure becomes more important because large models require massive computing power.

Alphabet reported that Google Cloud revenue increased 63% year-on-year to \$20.028 billion in Q1 2026. It also stated that cloud backlog nearly doubled quarter-on-quarter to over \$460 billion, showing strong demand for AI products and infrastructure.

### Major Cloud Components

|                                                                                            |                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Compute</b><br><br>Virtual machines, containers, GPUs, TPUs and serverless computing.   | <b>Data</b><br><br>BigQuery, databases, storage and analytics pipelines.                                         |
| <b>AI</b><br><br>Vertex AI, Gemini Enterprise, model APIs and agent platforms.             | <b>Security</b><br><br>Cloud security, threat detection and the Wiz acquisition for cloud security capabilities. |
| <b>Workspace</b><br><br>Gmail, Docs, Meet, Drive and productivity tools for organizations. | <b>Network</b><br><br>Global data centers and low-latency infrastructure.                                        |

Source note: Alphabet Q1 2026 earnings release and Google CEO remarks on Q1 2026 performance.

## 9. Search Algorithms and Machine Learning

Search algorithms are procedures that help a system find and rank information. Google uses hundreds of signals to decide which webpages, videos, images, maps listings or shopping results are likely to be most useful for a query.

Machine learning improves search by helping systems understand language, intent, context and patterns. Instead of only matching exact words, modern search can interpret meaning and relationships.

| Technology          | Role in Search and AI                                                                                 |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PageRank            | Early link-analysis method that estimated webpage importance using links.                             |
| RankBrain           | Machine learning system that helped interpret unfamiliar or ambiguous queries.                        |
| BERT                | Language model approach that improved understanding of context in sentences.                          |
| MUM / Multimodal AI | Systems designed to understand information across languages and formats.                              |
| Gemini              | Google's generative AI model family used across Search, Workspace, Cloud, Android and the Gemini app. |

### Example

A search for 'best low budget smartphone for online classes in India' requires more than keyword matching. Google must understand price sensitivity, location, product category, educational use case, reviews, freshness and commercial relevance.



## 10. Gemini and Generative AI Ecosystem

Gemini is Google's family of generative AI models and applications. It is used in the Gemini app, Google Search, Workspace, Android, Chrome and Google Cloud. Generative AI can create text, code, images, video, summaries and interactive learning tools.

In Q1 2026, Alphabet said first-party models such as Gemini were processing more than 16 billion tokens per minute via direct API use by customers. This indicates large-scale enterprise and developer usage of Google's AI models.

### Gemini Uses

|                                                                                                       |                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Students</b><br><br>Explanations, quizzes, summaries, translation and study planning.              | <b>Developers</b><br><br>Code assistance, API integration, debugging and app development. |
| <b>Businesses</b><br><br>Customer support agents, document search, analytics and workflow automation. | <b>Creators</b><br><br>Image, video, music, idea generation and content planning.         |

### Risks

- AI hallucinations can produce inaccurate answers.
- Students may overuse AI instead of developing original thinking.
- Generated content can raise plagiarism and authorship questions.
- Training data and copyright questions remain debated globally.

*Source note: Alphabet Q1 2026 earnings release and Google CEO Q1 2026 remarks.*

## 11. Privacy, Cookies and Data Handling

Google products work better when they use data such as search terms, location, watch history, language, device information and user preferences. This data can improve personalization, fraud prevention, security and advertising relevance. However, it also creates privacy risks.

### Privacy Sandbox and Cookies

A 2025 CMA progress report noted Google's April 2025 decision to maintain the current approach to third-party cookies in Chrome and not roll out a new standalone third-party cookie prompt. The report also discussed continued Privacy Sandbox work and tracking protections.

### Benefits vs Concerns

| Benefit                                 | Concern                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Personalized search and recommendations | User profiling and reduced anonymity           |
| Relevant advertising                    | Tracking across websites and apps              |
| Location-based maps and services        | Location privacy and surveillance concerns     |
| AI-powered assistance                   | Questions about data use for model improvement |
| Free consumer services                  | Dependence on a data-driven advertising model  |

Good user practices include reviewing Google Account privacy settings, using auto-delete controls, checking location history, managing ad personalization and understanding app permissions.

*Source note: UK CMA Privacy Sandbox Progress Report to the CMA, Q1 2025.*

## 12. Legal and Regulatory Challenges

Google faces legal scrutiny because of its size and influence in search, advertising, app distribution, browsers, data and AI. Regulators often ask whether Google's products help consumers while also limiting competition.

### Recent Developments

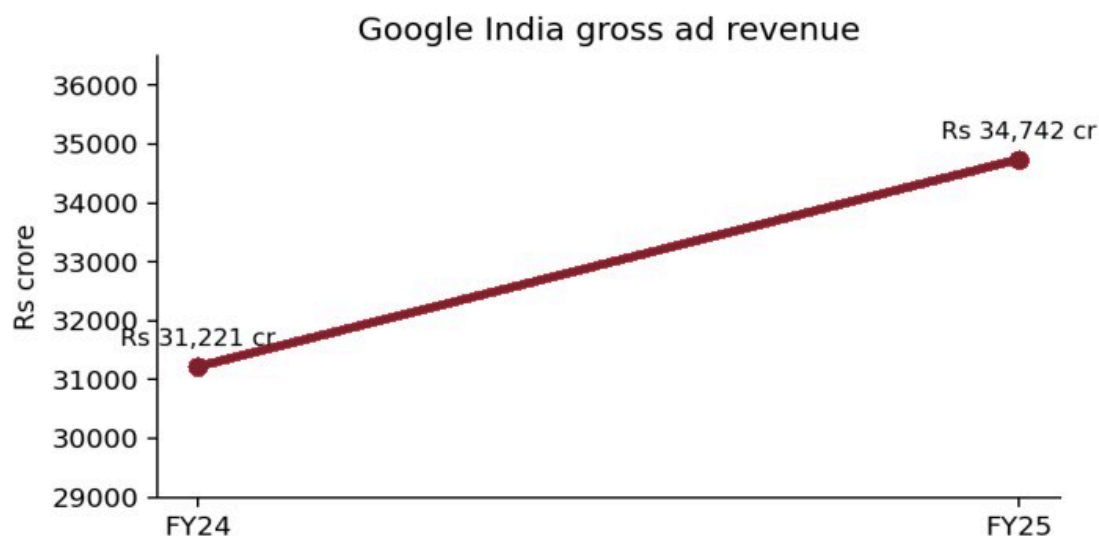
| Issue                 | Updated development                                                                                                                                 | Why it matters                                                                            |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| U.S. search antitrust | The U.S. Department of Justice announced significant remedies against Google in an online search monopolization case.                               | Search distribution, default agreements and access to search data can affect competition. |
| European DMA          | The European Commission sent preliminary findings to Alphabet in March 2025 concerning Google Search and Google Play under the Digital Markets Act. | The DMA targets gatekeeper platforms and self-preferencing risks.                         |
| Privacy and cookies   | Google's cookie strategy and Privacy Sandbox changes continue to be monitored by UK regulators.                                                     | Privacy changes can affect users, advertisers and rival ad-tech companies.                |
| AI governance         | AI search, AI-generated content and model training raise transparency, copyright and safety questions.                                              | AI regulation is becoming a central technology policy issue.                              |

Investigative point: Google's scale creates a policy dilemma. The same integration that makes services convenient can also make it difficult for smaller rivals to compete.

Source note: U.S. Department of Justice, European Commission Digital Markets Act materials and UK CMA materials.

## 13. Localization and Google in India

India is one of Google's most important markets because of its large internet user base, Android adoption, YouTube creators, local-language users, digital payments and small business ecosystem.



*Source note: Moneycontrol report based on company filings: Google India's gross ad revenue rose 11.3% to Rs 34,742 crore in FY25 from Rs 31,221 crore in FY24.*

### Forms of Localization

|                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Languages</b><br><br>Search, Translate, voice input and YouTube content support Indian languages. | <b>Maps</b><br><br>Traffic, local landmarks, businesses, public transport and navigation adapt to Indian conditions. |
| <b>Education</b><br><br>YouTube, Google Classroom, Docs and Search are widely used by students.      | <b>Payments and Commerce</b><br><br>Google Pay and local business discovery connect users with shops and services.   |



## 14. Local Businesses and Competition

Google can help small businesses become visible online through Search, Maps, reviews, photos and Google Business Profile. A coaching centre, clinic, bakery, repair shop or stationery store can reach nearby customers without building a complex website.

### How Google Ranks Local Businesses

| Ranking factor | Meaning for a local business                                                               |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Relevance      | How well the business matches the user's search query.                                     |
| Distance       | How close the business is to the user's location or searched area.                         |
| Prominence     | How well-known and trusted the business appears to be, including reviews and web mentions. |
| Freshness      | Updated hours, photos, phone numbers and posts improve reliability.                        |
| Reviews        | Ratings and customer comments influence trust and click behavior.                          |

### Benefits and Risks

| Benefits                                                                   | Risks                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Local discovery, low-cost visibility, customer reviews and map navigation. | Dependence on Google's ranking system, negative review impact and pressure to buy ads. |

Mini investigation: A comparison of three local services on Google Maps shows that review quality, photos, category accuracy, distance and updated business information strongly influence visibility.

## 15. Work Culture and Employee Management

Google is known for an innovation-driven work culture, collaborative teams, employee benefits and a strong engineering identity. Its culture encourages experimentation and product development at scale. At the same time, large technology companies face pressure from competition, rapid AI shifts, restructuring and ethical debates.

### Key Features

|                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mission focus</b><br><br>Employees are encouraged to build products that organize information and help users.   | <b>Collaboration</b><br><br>Cross-functional teams work across engineering, design, product, policy and operations. |
| <b>Innovation</b><br><br>AI, cloud, search, security and hardware require continuous research and experimentation. | <b>Benefits</b><br><br>Technology companies often provide health, food, flexibility and learning benefits.          |
| <b>Pressure</b><br><br>High expectations, AI competition and restructuring can create workplace stress.            | <b>Ethics</b><br><br>Employees and society question how technology affects privacy, fairness and public life.       |

Balanced view: Google's workplace image is associated with creativity and strong benefits, but its employees also work inside a highly competitive business environment where product decisions can affect billions of people.

## 16. Intellectual Property and AI Copyright

Intellectual property, or IP, includes copyrights, patents, trademarks, trade secrets and ownership rights over creative or technical work. For Google, IP issues appear in search results, YouTube copyright claims, app policies, employee inventions and AI model training.

### AI Copyright Debate

Generative AI systems learn from large amounts of data. This creates questions about whether copyrighted books, news articles, images, music, videos or code can be used for training without permission, and whether creators should be paid when AI systems generate competing outputs.

| Area              | Issue                                         | Example question                                    |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Training data     | Use of copyrighted works in model development | Should publishers and artists be compensated?       |
| Generated content | Ownership of AI-generated outputs             | Who owns an image or essay made by AI?              |
| Search summaries  | AI answers may summarize publisher content    | Does this reduce traffic to original sources?       |
| YouTube           | Copyright claims and Content ID               | How should fair use and creator rights be balanced? |
| Employee code     | Ownership of work produced inside a company   | Can employees retain IP rights for side projects?   |

Investigative point: AI can make knowledge more accessible, but it can also blur the boundary between learning from content and copying from creators.

## 17. Student Survey Methodology

To make the project investigative, a short survey can be conducted among 25 to 40 students, teachers or family members. The survey should examine how people use Google products, whether they trust Google's data handling, and how they view AI tools such as Gemini and AI Overviews.

### Proposed Questionnaire

- Which Google product do you use most: Search, YouTube, Gmail, Maps, Drive, Classroom or Gemini?
- How many times do you use Google Search daily: 1-2, 3-5 or more than 5?
- Do you use YouTube for education: yes, no or sometimes?
- Have you used Gemini or any AI chatbot?
- Do you trust Google with your personal data: yes, no or not sure?
- Do you think students are becoming overdependent on Google?
- Are AI summaries in Search helpful?
- Should Google be more transparent about data collection?

### Method

Collect responses using a printed form or Google Form. Convert results into percentages. Present at least two charts: one for most-used Google product and one for trust in data handling. Add a short interpretation below each chart.

*Ethics note: Do not collect sensitive personal data. Keep responses anonymous and use them only for this school project.*

## 18. Survey Analysis and Findings

The following analysis format presents a standard response pattern for a school-level investigative project. It can be supported with a short anonymous class survey, teacher feedback or secondary research observations.

| Finding area         | Example interpretation                                                                                  |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Most used product    | YouTube: 38%, Search: 32%, Gmail: 10%, Maps: 8%, Drive/Classroom: 8%, Gemini: 4%                        |
| Use of Google Search | Most respondents use Search more than three times daily.                                                |
| Education            | A majority use YouTube or Search for study support.                                                     |
| AI adoption          | Students are aware of AI chatbots, but not all use Gemini regularly.                                    |
| Privacy              | Many users are unsure about how Google handles personal data.                                           |
| Overdependence       | Respondents agree that students should verify information instead of blindly copying from Search or AI. |

### Main Findings from Secondary Research

- Google remains the world's dominant search engine with 90.04% global market share in April 2026.
- Advertising is still the main revenue engine, but cloud and AI are growing rapidly.
- AI Overviews and AI Mode are changing search from link discovery to answer generation.
- Google is useful for students and businesses, but privacy, competition and copyright issues remain important.
- In India, Google plays a major role in education, advertising, local discovery, video content and digital services.



## 19. Conclusion

Google has evolved from a simple search engine into one of the most powerful digital ecosystems in the world. Its services influence education, communication, entertainment, shopping, maps, business discovery, advertising and cloud computing.

Updated data shows that Alphabet continues to grow strongly. The company crossed \$400 billion in annual revenue in 2025, reported \$109.896 billion revenue in Q1 2026, and showed rapid Google Cloud growth. Search remains central to Google's business, while Gemini and AI Overviews indicate that the future of search will be more conversational and AI-driven.

However, Google also raises serious questions. A company that organizes information for billions of users also has power over visibility, advertising markets, data flows and digital habits. Privacy concerns, antitrust cases, AI copyright debates and publisher traffic issues show that Google should be studied critically, not only admired for innovation.

### Final Statement

Google's greatest strength is its ability to make technology useful at global scale. Its greatest challenge is to use that power responsibly, transparently and fairly while protecting users, creators, businesses and society.

## 20. Bibliography

The following public sources were used for updated data, statistics and recent developments.

| No. | Source                                            | Use in project                                                                         |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Alphabet Q4 and FY 2025 Earnings Release          | Annual revenue, net income, 2025 revenue lines, paid subscriptions and Cloud run-rate. |
| 2   | Alphabet Q1 2026 Earnings Release                 | Q1 2026 revenue, Search, YouTube ads, Cloud, employees and AI-token scale.             |
| 3   | Google I/O 2025 official blog                     | AI Overviews scale, AI Mode, Gemini in Search and AI product announcements.            |
| 4   | StatCounter Global Stats                          | Worldwide search engine market share, April 2026.                                      |
| 5   | UK CMA Privacy Sandbox Progress Report            | Third-party cookies, Chrome and Privacy Sandbox updates.                               |
| 6   | U.S. Department of Justice                        | Recent Google search antitrust remedies and competition concerns.                      |
| 7   | European Commission Digital Markets Act materials | Preliminary findings on Google Search and Google Play.                                 |
| 8   | Moneycontrol report on Google India FY25          | Google India gross advertising revenue for FY25.                                       |
| 9   | Google / About Google materials                   | Company background, products and mission.                                              |

### Selected URLs for reference

<https://abc.xyz/investor/>

<https://blog.google/innovation-and-ai/products/google-io-2025-all-our-announcements/>

<https://gs.statcounter.com/search-engine-market-share>

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End of Project